

Unit 6 — The Non-Fiction Essay

Track E · Klasse 12 · Niveau E (Basisfach / Leistungsfach)



Niveau E

1. Reading

Read the text, then answer in full sentences.

The essayist begins with a small autobiographical scene: code-switching between two voices in her own family. The anecdote is small, specific, domestic. By the third paragraph, the anecdote has become an argument about voice and authenticity. By the fifth, the argument has opened onto a moral turn — that single voice is a political demand, not a personal achievement. The closing returns to the autobiographical scene with new resonance.

2. Practise

1. Match: anecdote-as-argument → small story doing argumentative work; moral turn → the essay's ethical shift; elliptical close → unfinished but resonant ending.
2. T or F: the essayist's I is the same as the fiction-writer's narrator; non-fiction essays always open with the thesis.
3. Build 3 sentences using essayistic-prose vocabulary on Smith's opening.

3. Write

Non-fiction essay (your own), 400 words. Use the *anecdote-as-argument* move: open with a small personal scene, develop into an argument by paragraph 3, hit a moral turn by paragraph 5, return to the scene at the close. Use 4 academic discourse markers + 2 hedges + 1 cleft.

Lösungen **Controlled.** 1. all true.

2. F (different conventions: the essayist's / carries personal accountability), F (often the thesis lands later, after an anecdote).

Productive. 3. Open.